

Maria Silva

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LLB and LLM graduate with practical litigation experience gained at Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner, Citizens Advice and Q-Legal. At BCLP I supported an international arbitration through to submission and prepared court bundles, skeleton argument materials and filings in the Real Estate Disputes team. Experienced in legal research, document review, electronic bundling, deadline and case-file management, and drafting procedural documents. Now advising clients at Citizens Advice across housing, employment and benefits matters, managing cases from instruction through to submission.

EDUCATION

Comparative and International Dispute Resolution LLM — Merit **Sept 2024 – Oct 2025**

Queen Mary University of London

- International arbitration, dispute resolution procedure, legal research and evidence analysis
- Dissertation: data protection and GDPR development across jurisdictions
- Transnational Law and Governance Applied module (data privacy and democracy) — 75%

Law LLB — 2:1

Sept 2020 – June 2024

University College London

- Alternative Dispute Resolution, Advanced Contract Law, Commercial Law, Company Law

International Foundation Programme of Law and International Relations

Sept 2019 – June 2020

King's College London

- Leaders of Tomorrow prize: top 20 of a 200-student cohort; partial funding toward undergraduate degree

EXPERIENCE

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London

Aug 2023 – Feb 2024

Legal Placement Student — International Arbitration

- Supported a complex investment arbitration through to submission: reviewed and organised evidence for procedural submissions and the Claimant's memorial; amended memorial sections and drafted procedural orders and procedural histories
- Became the only junior supporting the team shortly before a significant deadline; coordinated documents, tracked outstanding actions and helped ensure on-time submission
- Maintained structured electronic case files; monitored procedural deadlines; liaised with the client on required documents and coordinated external translations
- Received feedback from a partner and associate that performance was comparable to a newly qualified solicitor

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London

Feb 2024 – Aug 2024

Legal Placement Student — Real Estate Disputes

- Prepared electronic hearing bundles and assisted with skeleton arguments and other court materials
- Conducted legal and factual research on rights of light, easements, leasehold issues and landlord and tenant disputes
- Assisted with court filings, hearing arrangements, matter opening and closure, and deadline tracking
- Maintained matter records via iManage; managed large volumes of confidential documents across several matters with competing deadlines

Citizens Advice East Berkshire · Maidenhead

July 2026 – Present

Legal Adviser

- Manages matters from instruction through to submission across housing, employment, welfare, debt and family matters: drafts correspondence, prepares applications and document schedules, maintains confidential case records and meets deadlines

- Interviews clients, takes detailed factual statements, establishes chronologies and identifies relevant legal and evidential issues
- Advises clients on procedural requirements and options; translates complex rules into clear, practical guidance for vulnerable individuals

Q-Legal · London

Oct 2024 – Jan 2025

Legal Adviser

- Managed a data-privacy matter from client instruction through to a formal written advice letter under a qualified solicitor's supervision
- Researched UK GDPR and Data Protection Act 2018 obligations; identified legal and compliance risks and recommended practical mitigations
- Coordinated with the client and supervising solicitor to meet the agreed deadline

Adobe · London

June 2022 – Aug 2022

Legal Intern

- Reviewed and amended software licensing agreements; identified contractual risks and assessed alignment with internal legal and compliance requirements
- Reviewed confidentiality and data-processing provisions; researched UK GDPR, EU GDPR and cross-border data transfer requirements
- Liaised with sales, legal and international business teams to resolve contractual queries; communicated amendments to stakeholders
- Prepared and delivered an internal presentation on breach-of-contract risks and mitigation measures

SKILLS

Languages: Portuguese (native), English (fluent), Spanish (basic)

Technical skills: Legal and commercial research; document review and analysis; electronic bundling; iManage; electronic court filing portals; case management and time-recording systems; Microsoft Word, Excel and PowerPoint; legal research databases; concise report and correspondence writing

Case and evidence management: Evidence review, hearing bundle preparation, procedural histories, case-file organisation, deadline tracking across multiple concurrent matters